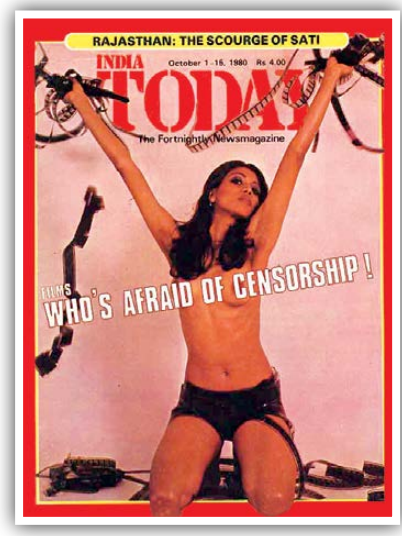
50TH ANNIVERSARY

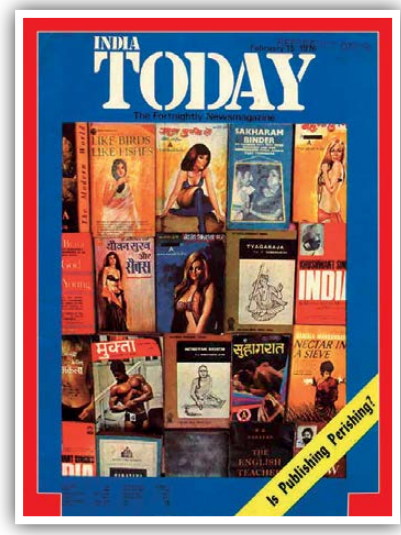
TRENDS
1975-1985

HOLDING A MIRROR

From the reach of tech and cosmetics to sexuality, porn and the market price of Husain's art, INDIA TODAY had its ear to the ground and finger on the nation's pulse



▲ Oct. 15, 1980



▲ Feb. 15, 1976



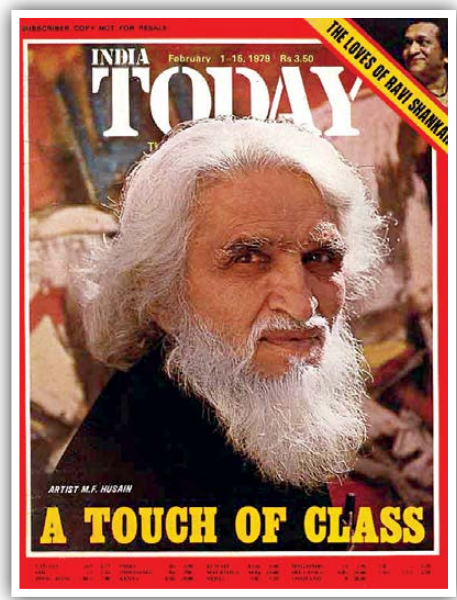
▲ Dec. 31, 1976

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During INDIA TODAY's first decade, the nation changed without announcing it. The magazine looked beyond power and policy. It watched everyday life. It tracked habits. It paid attention to what people bought, feared, read, watched, and hid. It asked an unfashionable question. What does development actually achieve? Science, it found, stayed urban. Technology skipped villages. Progress moved faster than people could follow. The country was modernising unevenly, and the cost was quiet migration.

Consumption arrived not suddenly, but steadily. Televisions entered middle-class homes. Scooters became aspirational goals. Credit followed confidence. INDIA TODAY mapped this consumer boom with numbers, not hype, and showed how a restrained economy was learning to spend.

Alongside goods came images. Video cassettes changed leisure. Small towns adopted the medium faster than metros. INDIA TODAY saw video not as entertainment alone, but as a cultural shift. The body, too, became a site of change. Cosmetics stopped being a mere indulgence. Beauty moved from privilege to habit. This magazine read the boom as a marker of urban confidence and changing gender norms.



▲ Feb. 15, 1979

In 1978, a major IMRB survey for INDIA TODAY found that, despite talk of declining morals, most college boys wanted to marry virgins, while most college girls had never kissed a man on the lips. The findings revealed a so-